

4.2 Stair-ing Up At The Sky

Unless you're designing buildings for supremely lazy people, you'll want to build stairs some time or the other. There are three methods you could use, each with its own benefits and compromises—it's either easy and inflexible, or a little challenging and incredibly tweak-able.

But First, Some Stair-talk

Rise And Run: The *rise* of your staircase is its total height—in other words, the total vertical distance it travels. The *run* is the total horizontal distance it travels.

Tread: Each step is called a *tread*.

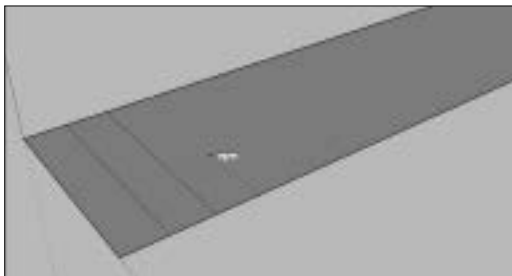
Riser: This is, well, the part that rises and connects one step to another. Stairs need not always have risers—we're sure you've seen stairs with gaps between them.

Landing: These are areas where the stairs flatten out—between storeys, for example.

4.2.1 The Subdivided Rectangle Method

This is the easiest in terms of the skill you require, but it's still quite tedious. The idea is to split a rectangle into a number of segments—one for each step, and then raise each segment in ascending order to create the entire flight. Start with a rectangle—the width should be what you want for your stairs, and the length should be the run length. Select one of the long edges of the rectangle, right-click and choose Divide. Use the VCB to enter the number of segments you want to divide the edge into.

If your rectangle is along one of the axes, you can start segmenting right away—using the



Starting with segmenting